



NATIONAL ECONOMICS UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Chapter 3

Elicitation and Stakeholder Collaboration



Chapter 3: Elicitation and Stakeholder Collaboration

- **Content:**

- 3.1 Introduction to elicitation & Stakeholder Collaboration

- 3.2 Elicitation & Collaboration Process

- 3.3 Practical Elicitation & Stakeholder Collaboration

3.1 Introduction

- **Elicitation and Collaboration:** describes the *tasks that business analysts perform to prepare for and conduct* elicitation activities and *confirm* the results obtained. It also describes the *communication with stakeholders* once the business analysis information is assembled and the ongoing collaboration with them throughout the business analysis activities.
 - Elicitation: activities used to draw out or obtain information from stakeholders and other sources to discover requirements.
 - Collaboration: two or more people working together toward a common goal.
- Elicitation and collaboration are continuous throughout Business Analysis.

Benefits of Elicitation

- Clearly understand and define scope, budget, risks, and other project boundaries.
- Reduce requirement gaps in later stages.
- Enable effective communication of business value.
- Clarify ***assumed and hidden requirements***.
 - The system shall allow customers to place orders online → generate an order ID, record order date/time.
calculate order total, delivery information, payment information, send order confirmation...
 - The system shall provide a mobile application <> why → Students need timely access to their class schedules →
solution: Web portal, Mobile app, Zalo notification, Email, SMS..
- Support development of relevant functions and solutions.

Challenges to Project Success

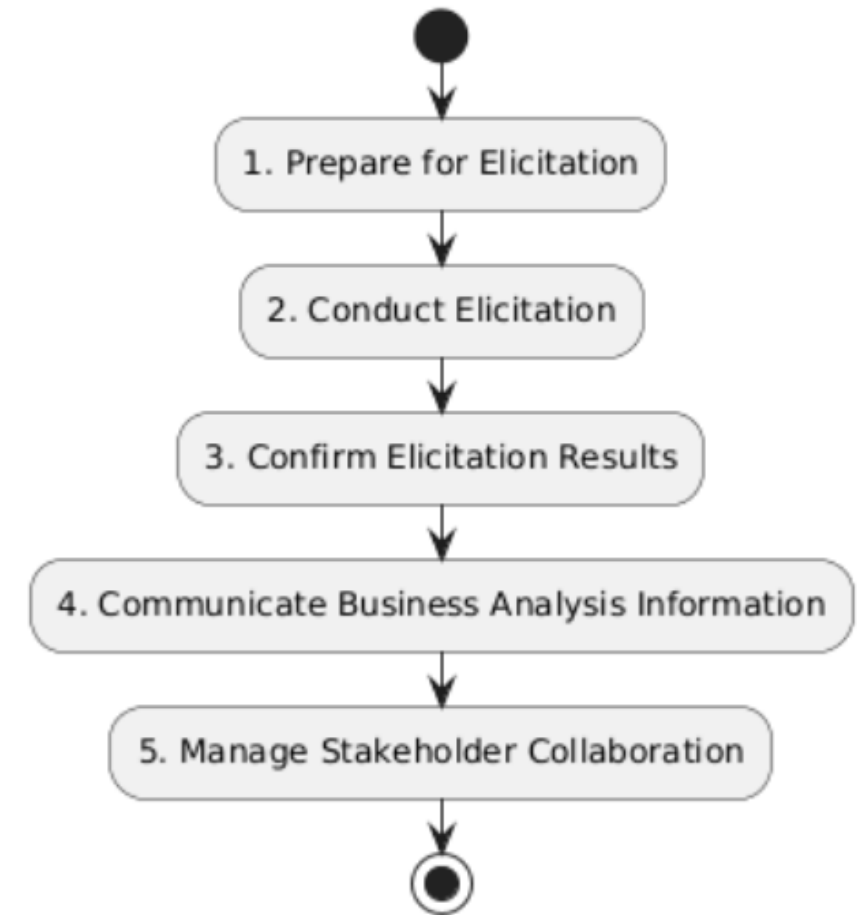
- Poorly defined project scope
- Inadequate risk management
- Ineffective communication
- Insufficient documentation
- Poor requirements traceability
- Inadequate progress tracking
- Insufficient information during project planning

Challenges in Elicitation

- Complex or unfamiliar domain
- Unclear vision and project objectives
- Rigid stakeholders or processes
- Conflicting requirements
- Assumed requirements
- Unbounded or continuously changing requirements
- Limited access to documentation
- Focusing on solutions instead of requirements

3.2 Elicitation & Collaboration Process

1. Prepare for Elicitation
2. Conduct Elicitation
3. Confirm Elicitation Results
4. Communicate Business Analysis Information
5. Manage Stakeholder Collaboration



Key flow: Plan → Elicit → Confirm → Communicate → Collaborate → Improve

3.2 Elicitation & Collaboration Process

3.2.1 Prepare for Elicitation

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation

3.2.3 Confirm Elicitation Results

3.2.4 Communicate Business Analysis Information

3.2.5 Manage Stakeholder Collaboration

3.2.1 Prepare for Elicitation - Purpose

Purpose

- Understand the scope of the elicitation activity.
- Select appropriate elicitation techniques.
- Plan supporting materials and resources.

BA prepares by defining expected outcomes, relevant stakeholders, objectives, techniques, controls, and supporting resources.

3.2.1 Prepare for Elicitation – Inputs

- Requirements: provide initial scope and purpose for elicitation.
- Stakeholder Engagement Approach: helps identify communication and collaboration needs.
- Even when elicitation is used to discover requirements, some initial requirements are usually available.

3.2.1 Prepare for Elicitation – Components

- Understand the elicitation scope
- Select the elicitation approach
- Establish logistics
- Prepare supporting resources and tools
- Prepare stakeholders

3.2.1 Prepare for Elicitation – Techniques

- Data exploration
- Document analysis
- Interview
- Estimation
- Brainstorming
- Mind mapping
- Risk analysis and management
- List of viewpoints

3.2.1 Prepare for Elicitation – Stakeholders & Output

Potential stakeholders

- Domain experts
- Project managers
- Sponsors

Output

- Elicitation Activity Plan: logistics, scope, selected techniques, and supporting materials.

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation

Purpose

- Discover and identify information relevant to the change.

Common types of elicitation:

1. **Collaboration** – work directly with stakeholders.
2. **Research** – systematically explore information from documents and other sources.
3. **Experimentation** – discover information through controlled experiments, observation, proof of concept, and prototypes.

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Stakeholder and Components

Stakeholders may:

- Participate and collaborate in elicitation activities.
- Review and provide feedback on documents, systems, models, and interfaces.

Key components:

- Facilitate the elicitation activity.
- Capture and integrate elicitation results.

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques

- Benchmarking and market analysis
- Business rules analysis
- Concept modelling
- **Process modelling:**
- **Data modelling**
- Interface analysis
- Document analysis
- Observation
- Interviews
- Surveys / questionnaires
- Brainstorming
- **Focus groups**
- Workshops
- Mind mapping

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques - Process modelling

- Process modelling:
 - Flowchart
 - **UML Activity Diagram**
 - BPMN
 - SIPOC
 - Value Stream Map
 - Customer Journey Map

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques - Data modelling

Techniques	Goal	Example
Entity-Relationship Diagram	Xác định entity và quan hệ	Student – Class – Enrollment
Class Diagram	Mô hình hóa cấu trúc đối tượng/dữ liệu	Student, Course, Teacher
Data Flow Diagram (DFD)	Mô tả dữ liệu di chuyển qua hệ thống	Student Information → System
Conceptual Data Model	Xác định các khái niệm dữ liệu ở mức nghiệp vụ	Student, Course, Class
Logical Data Model	Mô tả chi tiết cấu trúc dữ liệu	StudentID, Name, DOB...
Physical Data Model	Mô tả cách dữ liệu được lưu trữ trong DB	Tables, columns, PK, FK
Data Dictionary	Định nghĩa chi tiết các thành phần dữ liệu	StudentID: unique identifier
CRUD Matrix	Xác định ai/process nào Create, Read, Update, Delete DL	Staff → Student
CRUD Analysis	Phân tích vòng đời và quyền thao tác DL	Create/Read/Update/Delete
State Model	Mô tả trạng thái và sự chuyển đổi của dữ liệu/đối tượng	Student: Registered → Active → Graduated
Data Mapping	Xác định sự tương ứng giữa các trường DL	Excel.StudentName → System.Name
Data Classification	Phân loại dữ liệu theo tính chất/mức độ nhạy cảm	Public, Internal, Confidential

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Output

Output: Unconfirmed Elicitation Results

These are the information captured during an elicitation activity in a form appropriate for further analysis and confirmation.

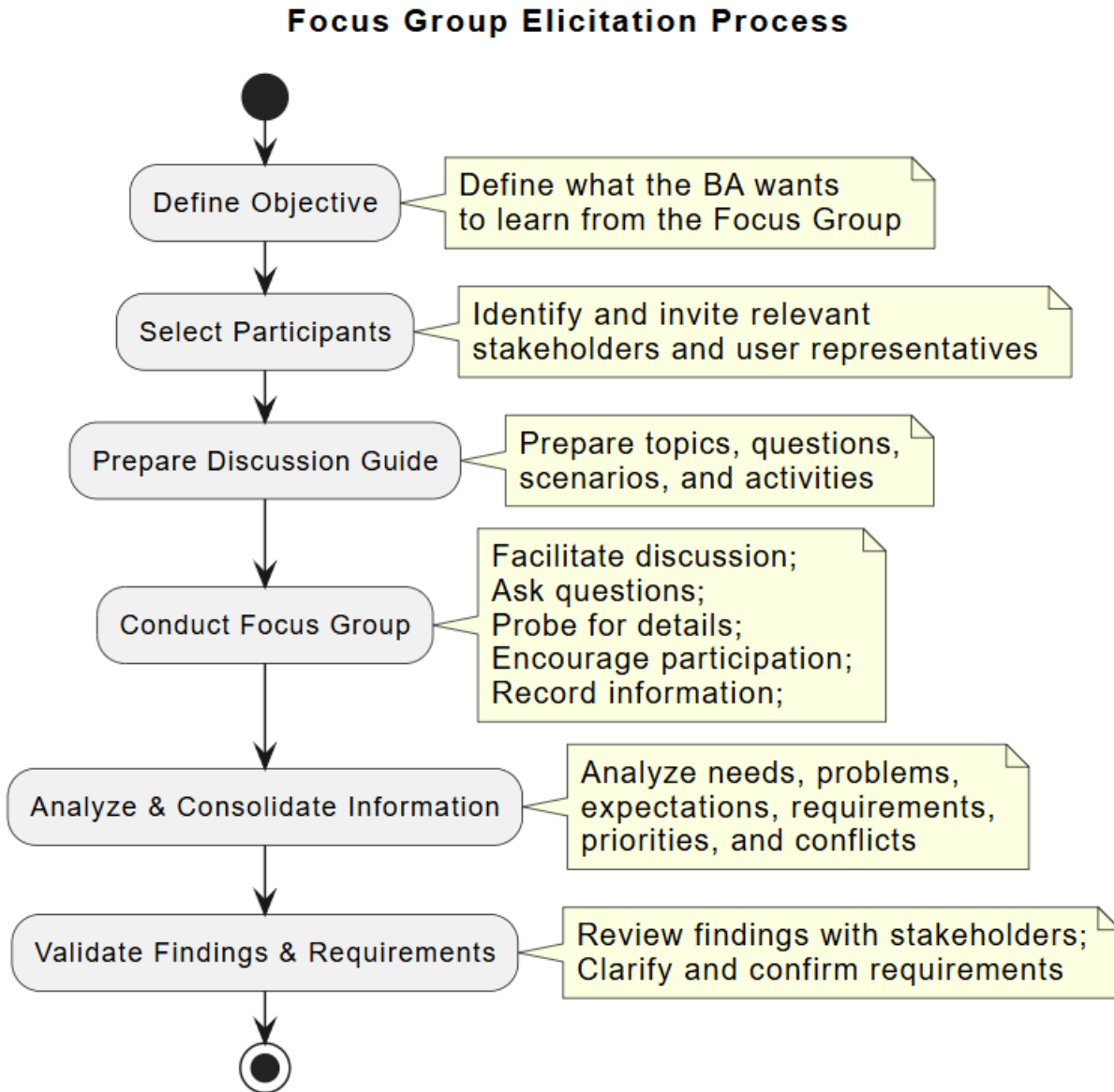
3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques – Focus group

- **Focus Group** is an elicitation technique in which a Business Analyst brings together a small group of stakeholders to **discuss a specific topic, problem, product, or solution** in a structured and facilitated session.
- The purpose: collect different perspectives, needs, expectations, concerns, and requirements through **interactive group discussion**.

Focus Group = Structured discussion + Multiple stakeholders + Facilitated by the BA

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques – Focus group

- **Process:**



3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques – Focus group

Techniques in Focus group

Techniques	Mô tả
Open-ended questions	Khuyến khích chia sẻ với các dạng câu hỏi khác nhau
Probing questions	Đào sâu vấn đề: khám phá tìm thông tin có giá trị
Follow-up questions	Làm rõ thông tin
Brainstorming	Tạo nhiều ý tưởng
Voting	Xác định ưu tiên
Ranking	Xếp hạng yêu cầu
Dot voting	Bình chọn nhanh
Scenario discussion	Thảo luận tình huống
Prototype review	Đánh giá giao diện/giải pháp

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques – Focus group

- **Example:**

- Business Need:**

- The center needs to manage students and classes more effectively.
 - This is **not yet a requirement**.
 - Based on this business need, we can derive the following:

- Requirements:**

- The system shall allow staff to create and update student profiles.
 - The system shall allow staff to manage classes.
 - The system shall allow teachers to record attendance.
 - The system shall send class schedule notifications to students.
 - The system shall provide class performance reports.

3.2.2 Conduct Elicitation – Techniques – Focus group

In-class exercise: Use the Focus Group technique to **identify the Business Needs** of your group project (including the business problems and goals that the organization needs to address)

3.2.3 Confirm Elicitation Results

Purpose

- Check collected information for accuracy and consistency with other information.

Confirmation helps identify:

- Errors
- Omissions
- Conflicts
- Ambiguities

Results are compared with their sources and with other elicitation results.

3.2.3 Confirm Elicitation Results – Inputs & Components

Input

- Unconfirmed Elicitation Results

Components

- Compare results with source information: correctness, clarity, etc.
- Compare results with other elicitation results: consistency, accuracy, etc.

3.2.3 Confirm Elicitation Results – Techniques

- Document analysis → validate cited information.
- Interview → clarify and confirm integrated information.
- Reviews → confirm results are accurate, useful, and relevant.
- Workshops → resolve issues and reach shared understanding.

3.2.3 Confirmed Elicitation Results

Output

- Confirmed Elicitation Results

A consolidated set of results agreed by the BA and relevant stakeholders to accurately represent the information collected and to be relevant and useful for subsequent work.

3.2.4 Communicate Business Analysis Information

Purpose

- Ensure stakeholders have a common understanding of Business Analysis information.

BA should communicate the right information:

- To the right stakeholders
- At the right time
- In the right format
- Using appropriate language, tone, and style

Communication is Two-Way

Business Analysis communication is iterative and two-way.

Consider:

- Who is the recipient?
- What is the content?
- What is the purpose?
- What is the context?
- What outcome is expected?

If stakeholders do not understand the information, adapt the communication method and use multiple formats when necessary.

Communicate BA Information – Components

1. Define communication objectives and format
 - Formal / informal documents
 - Presentations and overviews
2. Deliver the BA information package
 - Team collaboration
 - One-to-one communication
 - Email
 - Non-verbal communication

Communicate BA Information – Techniques & Stakeholders

Techniques

- Interview
- Review
- Workshop

Stakeholders

- End users
- Customers
- Domain experts
- Implementation experts
- Testers
- Any relevant stakeholder

Output: Communicated Business Analysis Information

3.2.5 Manage Stakeholder Collaboration

Purpose

- Encourage stakeholders to work toward a common goal.

Collaboration is continuous:

- Starts with stakeholder identification and analysis.
- New stakeholders may emerge.
- The greater the impact of change, the more important collaboration becomes.

Risks of Poor Stakeholder Alignment

Poor alignment can lead to:

- Low-quality information
- Negative reactions
- Resistance to change
- Low participation
- Limited support for Business Analysis

Manage Collaboration – Key Components

- Obtain agreement on commitments.
- Monitor stakeholder participation.
- Ensure appropriate attitude and engagement.
- Obtain timely confirmation of elicitation results.
- Maintain agreed commitments.
- Use regular two-way communication to sustain information flow and joint effort.

Manage Collaboration – Techniques

- Lessons learned → improve working relationships.
- Collaborative games → build teamwork.
- Risk analysis and management → address stakeholder participation and commitment risks.
- Stakeholder list → identify who is involved, relationships, and BA information relevant to each stakeholder.

Stakeholder Collaboration – Output

Output

- Stakeholder Engagement

Stakeholders are willing and able to participate and collaborate with the Business Analyst to achieve the desired outcomes.

3.3 Practical Elicitation & Stakeholder Collaboration

Practical workflow

1. Prepare for elicitation
2. Conduct elicitation
3. Document information
4. Confirm results

3.3.1 Prepare for Elicitation

- Learn the business domain
- Understand the current system
- Build a stakeholder list
- Prepare a question list
- Select elicitation techniques
- Plan the working sessions

Understand the Business Domain

Why?

- Use the stakeholder's language.
- Understand the information provided.
- Ask better elicitation questions.
- Build stakeholder trust.

Information to learn:

- Domain terminology
- Operating processes
- Rules and formulas
- Business models
- Similar product/service user guides
- Competitor products, when relevant

Business Model Canvas

Use the Business Model Canvas to understand the business context:

- Customer segments
- Value propositions
- Channels
- Customer relationships
- Revenue streams
- Key resources
- Key activities
- Key partners
- Cost structure

Understand the Existing System

Review relevant:

- Contracts
- Project requirements
- Customer-provided documents
- Existing software and tools
- Reference materials available online

Goal: understand the current context before asking stakeholders to describe requirements.

Build the Stakeholder List

Typical stakeholder categories

- End users
- Consultants
- Influencers
- Approvers

Sources

- Project documents and contracts
- Procedure/process documents
- Lessons from previous projects
- Organizational structure and responsibilities
- Previous discussions and stakeholder referrals

Analyze Stakeholders

Consider:

- Role and authority
- Personality and working style
- Attitude toward the project
- Attitude toward Business Analysis activities
- Approval responsibilities
- Relevant project information

Prepare the Question List – 5W1H

The 5W1H / Kipling Method uses:

- Who
- What
- Where
- When
- Why
- How

Useful for exploring a problem from multiple perspectives, generating ideas, and gaining deeper understanding.

5W1H – WHO

- Who uses this feature?
- Who provides the input?
- Who receives the output?
- Who uses the result?
- Who else should I ask?
- Who decides requirement changes?
- Who confirms requirement priorities?
- Who should be informed about changes?

5W1H – WHAT

- What is the business weakness?
- What change are we trying to achieve?
- What is the solution scope?
- What features are needed?
- What is the expected outcome?
- What happens next?
- What assumptions must be validated?
- What constraints must be recognized?

5W1H – WHERE

- Where does the process start?
- Where does the user access the feature?
- Where does the process problem occur?
- Where are documents stored?
- Where can current-system instructions be found?

5W1H – WHEN

- When is the feature needed?
- When are you ready to start?
- When do you need status information?
- When was the feature/process introduced?
- When can feedback be expected?
- When should the meeting invitation be sent?

5W1H – WHY

- Why are you doing this project?
- Why is this change important?
- Why add, remove, or modify this attribute?
- Why was this option selected?
- Is there another way to complete the task?
- Why do you think this weakness occurs?
- Why should legal considerations be included?

5W1H – HOW

- How does the requirement support business KPIs?
- How could the requirement be defined differently?
- How does it support organizational goals or strategy?
- How can I contact you about this issue?
- How can I clarify the issue?
- How can I help you with this task?

Selecting Elicitation Techniques

Choose techniques according to:

- Objective of the elicitation
- Type of information required
- Stakeholder characteristics
- Time and resource constraints
- Complexity of the problem
- Availability of existing information

Brainstorming

Use when:

- A quick set of possible solutions or ideas is needed.
- Many ideas are required.

Principles:

- No limit on ideas.
- Do not judge or evaluate ideas during idea generation.

Interview

Purpose

- Obtain detailed information directly from an individual stakeholder.

Useful when:

- The stakeholder has specific knowledge.
- Detailed clarification is needed.
- Follow-up questions can uncover hidden requirements.

Focus Group

- Discuss a specific issue, idea, or product.
- Participants are stakeholders who understand the discussion topic.
- Useful for eliciting requirements from a group.
- Encourages different perspectives and shared discussion.

Workshop

- Involves important stakeholders from multiple departments.
- Works toward previously defined objectives.

Typical topics:

- Project direction and scope
- Business and system requirements
- Proposed solutions
- Requirement review and approval

Observation

Purpose

- Understand how work is actually performed in the real environment.

Useful for:

- Discovering implicit requirements
- Identifying workarounds
- Understanding actual user behavior
- Comparing documented processes with real practice

Comparing Elicitation Techniques

Interview → detailed individual insight

Focus Group → group perspectives

Workshop → cross-functional alignment and decisions

Brainstorming → rapid idea generation

Observation → actual behavior and workflow

Select the technique—or combination of techniques—that best fits the situation.

3.3.2 Conduct Elicitation

During the session:

- Follow the elicitation plan.
- Facilitate discussion and participation.
- Ask structured and follow-up questions.
- Capture facts, assumptions, issues, and requirements.
- Distinguish current-state information from desired changes.
- Record results for later analysis and confirmation.

3.3.3 Document the Information

- Consolidate information for each stakeholder group.
- Transform stakeholder input into BA deliverables such as URD and BRD.
- Integrate detailed stakeholder information into the overall business picture.

Goal: turn scattered information into structured, traceable BA information.

3.3.4 Confirm the Information

Confirmation formats:

- Informal: email, meeting minutes, chat
- Formal: signed documents such as URD and BRD

Confirm with:

- Stakeholders who participated in elicitation
- Approvers / decision makers

Practice: English Center Management System

Task: elicit requirements for an English Center Management System.

Explore the domain:

- Terminology
- Organizational structure and roles
- Business model
- Operating processes
- Similar products in the market

Then:

- Identify stakeholders
- Build a RACI matrix
- Prepare 5W1H elicitation questions
- Select suitable elicitation techniques

Chapter 3 – Summary

Elicitation and stakeholder collaboration are continuous BA activities.

A practical BA cycle:

Prepare → Conduct → Confirm → Communicate → Collaborate

Key skills:

- Understand the domain
- Identify and analyze stakeholders
- Ask effective questions
- Select appropriate elicitation techniques
- Document and validate information
- Build shared understanding and commitment



Thank you for listening!

Q & A